

Simulated Incident Report — #1

Wazuh / Suricata Detection Lab

01 Alert Summary

INCIDENT #	SIM-001	DATE / TIME	Aug 10, 2026 @ 19:31:23.082
ATTACK TYPE	Brute Force Attack	SEVERITY	Medium severity, Rule Level 10
SOURCE	76.38.206.65	DESTINATION	54.84.165.65 (VM)
DETECTING TOOL	Wazuh — OpenSSH authentication-failure rule group, decoded from /var/log/auth.log		

02 Initial Triage

Detected a cluster of sequential "Failed password" logs via the Wazuh dashboard, originating from a common source IP and directed at SSH services within a concentrated timeframe. Initial triage assessed whether the traffic stemmed from authorized internal testing or an anonymous external entity and evaluated the frequency of the pattern. The absence of successful authentication suggests that credential compromise did not occur.

03 Investigation Steps

Reviewed /var/log/auth.log on the agent host and confirmed 100+ failed password attempts within ~45 seconds from the same source IP. Checked the Wazuh alert timeline for any correlating successful login or account-lockout event — none found. Confirmed no other rule groups (sudo, FIM) fired from the same source during the same window, indicating the activity was contained to authentication attempts only.

04 Verdict

TRUE POSITIVE

FALSE POSITIVE

Multiple failed login attempts from the same source IP within one minute. Volume and timing (100+ attempts in 45 seconds) are inconsistent with normal user mistyping and consistent with automated brute-force tooling.

05 MITRE ATT&CK

TECH ID#	NAME	TACTIC
T1110	Brute Force	Credential Access

06 Escalation

Incident resolved at Tier 1. Identified as a high-confidence TP; investigation confirmed no successful authentication occurred, and no indicators of lateral movement or account compromise were found. Escalation to Tier 2/IR would be required only upon detection of a successful login following the brute-force window or if the source IP targeted additional infrastructure.

07 Response / Remediation

Added source IP to the perimeter firewall block list. Implemented fail2ban rate limiting on SSH to automatically block repeat offenders going forward.

08 Lessons Learned / Tuning

Confirmed Wazuh's default SSH auth-failure rules fire reliably out of the box with no custom rule tuning required. Identified an opportunity to move from manual firewall-list updates to Wazuh's built-in active-response (firewall-drop) for automatic IP blocking on future brute-force detections, reducing response time from manual to automated.